

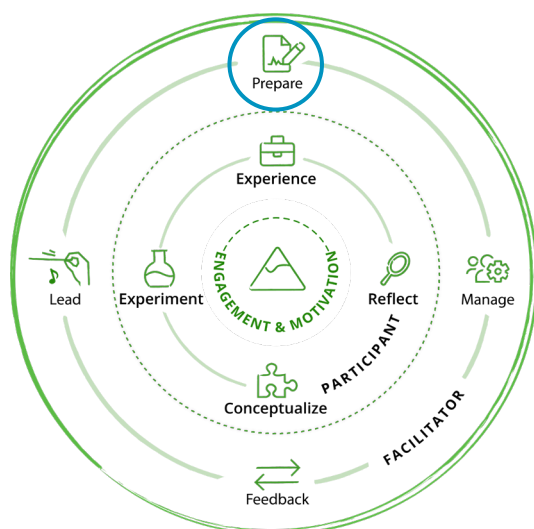


Effective storytelling

Storytelling is a core facilitation skill that enhances and enriches learning experiences. You may have listened to someone share a story and thought, “Where are they going with this?” or “How much longer until they get to the point?” Mastering the art of storytelling is a process that evolves over time.

When done correctly, storytelling allows participants to indirectly engage with an experience, fosters a sense of personal connection, and creates relatability to the topic at hand, and increases learning and retention. It is particularly effective when vulnerabilities such as mistakes and failures are shared, as they resonate deeply with listeners.

This guide delivers insights into storytelling as a learning tool—how you can create compelling narratives that can help you enhance the effectiveness and engagement of facilitated sessions. By utilizing the included worksheet to build a story, you'll be better equipped to deliver more compelling and interactive learning experiences.



Being prepared

Effective storytelling requires forethought, planning and practice. Preparing relevant stories is part of the **Prepare** component of the **Facilitator Ring** in the DFX Model.

- ✓ **Choose your stories carefully in advance** to ensure they are relevant and relatable.
- ✓ **Practice through rehearsals** to ensure your storytelling becomes more memorable, sincere, and concise.

Characteristics of an effective story

Brief

Keep your story short and to the point. A short story typically takes around three minutes to share.

Relatable

Create a story that allows the audience to walk in your shoes. True stories allow people to identify and connect.

Engaging

Create an interesting story to capture attention and be memorable.

Relevant

Ensure your story communicates the key message or learning point and connect to the topic at hand.

The 3 Ts of storytelling

The story should create the picture of a “journey” through a situation. The 3Ts story arc provides an easy-to-remember framework to structure any story. Here are the components to create compelling stories:



Takeoff

Set the context

- ✓ Describe the place, time, and environment where the story is based.
- ✓ Introduce the characters in the story.
- ✓ Explain how things looked before the imminent challenge or conflict.

Once the story is off the ground, you get to the flight itself. In our daily lives, we want our flights to be uneventful. But a story where everything goes smoothly is probably boring and ineffective. Problems make stories compelling.

Turbulence

Present the challenge or conflict

- ✓ Explain the issue(s) with clarity and be sure to include the drama.
- ✓ Use verbal and non-verbal cues to enhance the story.
- ✓ Use gestures and facial expressions to help with visualization.
- ✓ Use your voice to build energy or tension and to convey emotions.
- ✓ Choose descriptive, evocative words.

Once you successfully navigate the turbulence, you need to bring the audience to the destination. They should understand where the journey took them and why.

Touchdown

Describe the resolution to your audience

- ✓ Explain how the issue was resolved (successfully or unsuccessfully) and the outcome.
- ✓ Reveal the moral of the story, i.e., the lessons learned.
- ✓ Have a clearly defined endpoint.

Drama, **detail**, and **dialogue** are elements that should be used across each of the 3 Ts of storytelling to help your audience to step into the story and feel like they were present.



Drama

- ✓ Should be unexpected
- ✓ Transports us to a specific moment
- ✓ Empathizes with the characters



Detail

- ✓ Establishes specific time and place
- ✓ Paints the picture
- ✓ Engages our senses



Dialogue

- ✓ Actual quotes from story characters



Story planning worksheet

Let’s practice. Use the below area to **create your story arc**.

To get started, think of a situation and **define the simple truth** (goal or moral of the story). Now use the following steps to build the story with the help of key questions.



Takeoff introduces the situation, characters, and setting and establishes the narrative's direction is established. It is crucial because it sets the tone and context for the rest of the story, and this is where you grab the audience's attention.

Don't forget the ...
Drama Detail Dialogue



Turbulence introduces challenges, obstacles, or setbacks. Turbulence is essential to maintain the audience's interest and drive the story forward. It creates suspense and tension, making the story more engaging.

Don't forget the ...
Drama Detail Dialogue

Effective storytelling

The 3 Ts of storytelling

Story planning worksheet



Story planning worksheet



Touchdown is the point where the conflicts are resolved. It is the payoff for the audience's emotional investment in the story. It brings closure and underscores the story's theme or message and leaves a lasting impression on the audience.

Don't forget the ...



Drama



Detail



Dialogue

Key questions

Below are some key questions you can ask yourself to help build a strong narrative:

- ✓ Where and when did this happen?
- ✓ Who were you working with?
- ✓ How would you describe them?
- ✓ What did they say? What did you say?
- ✓ What challenges did you face?
- ✓ What obstacles did you encounter along the way?
- ✓ What were the outcomes, and what did you learn (aligns to simple truth)?
- ✓ What were the visuals that you could use to enhance your story?

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